

Lost & Found Web Application

Day 2 Documentation — Core Functionality & Authentication

Day 2 Overview

Day 2 focused on connecting the React frontend to the Express/MongoDB backend, implementing the main Lost & Found workflows, adding item details and basic matching, and completing user authentication.

Completed Steps

Step	Work Completed	Status
1	Connect Browse to MongoDB	Completed
2	Display category and status on Item Cards	Completed
3	Complete Report Found form	Completed
4	Save Found items to MongoDB	Completed
5	Improve Item Cards	Completed
6	Item Details page	Completed
7	Mark Found / Claimed	Completed
8	Basic rule-based matching	Completed
9	Login & Signup authentication	Completed
10	Final testing and fixes	Completed

1. Browse Items + MongoDB

Browse now retrieves item records from the backend API and MongoDB. Search works by item name, with status and category filters. Cards open the corresponding item using its MongoDB ID.

2. Report Lost / Report Found

Both reporting forms collect item name, category, description, date, location and an optional image field. Submitted records are sent to the Express API and saved in MongoDB.

3. Item Details

Clicking an item opens an Item Details page using the item's MongoDB ID and displays its name, status, category, description, date and location.

4. Status Updates

The Item Details page allows an item to be marked Found or Claimed. The change is sent to the backend and persisted in MongoDB.

5. Basic Matching Logic

The matching endpoint first looks for records with matching category, location and date, then checks shared keywords in names and descriptions. This is a simple rule-based approach.

6. User Authentication

Signup stores users in MongoDB with passwords hashed using bcryptjs. Login finds the user by email and compares the submitted password with the stored hash.

7. Profile / Logout Improvement

After the original Day 2 core plan was completed, a small login-state improvement was added using browser localStorage. The Profile page displays the saved user's name and email, and Logout clears the saved state.

Testing Completed

Test	Result
Signup	Passed
Correct login	Passed
Wrong password	Passed
Report Lost	Passed
Report Found	Passed
Browse/search/filter	Passed
Item Details	Passed
Basic matching	Passed
Mark Found/Claimed	Passed
MongoDB persistence	Passed
Profile/Logout	Passed

Current State After Day 2

The main user-facing workflow is functional end-to-end: registration, login, reporting lost/found items, browsing, searching/filtering, item details, basic matching, and status updates. MongoDB provides persistent item and user data.

Day 3 Plan

Day 3 will focus on the remaining assessment work: Admin functionality, UI polish, error handling/quality checks, and complete application testing.

No passwords, database credentials, connection strings, or other secrets are included in this document.